



Game Production Kickoff & Ideation

MTD.ba/DA.ba SS 2026, Hagenberg

What We Do Today

- > Recap of course goals & project constraints
- > Researching reference projects
- > Generating game ideas
- > Presenting game ideas (*until next week*)

Group Projects!

4-6 people (4 teams in each group in DA.ba and MTD.ba)

1 game prototype for 1 semester

(= 2,5 ECTS)

- Concept, production, documentation
- Working in teams, roles, version control, and communication
- Project management, estimations, quality assurance
- Pitching, presenting, advertising, PR



Game Constraints

~5–15 min playtime

- > Single player, standalone, PC & Mac, Unity
- > 3D game with 1st or 3rd person controller
- > *Simple gameplay...*
- > Only prototyping or low-poly assets
- > Simple or no UI
- > 4–6 ppl



“Simple Gameplay”

We recommend (& will provide basics) for **story-based adventure gameplay:**

Simple 1st or 3rd person interaction (*walk, look, pick up, listen to, read*), focus on storytelling and level design.

Think: Gone Home, Firewatch, Edith Finch, Amnesia, Dear Esther, The Stanley Parable, ...

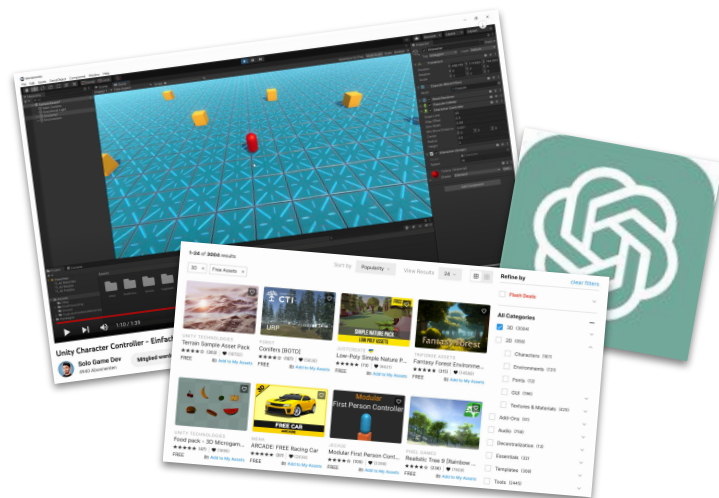


Custom Gameplay

Custom gameplay is a programming challenge & we won't be able to cover every custom request this semester. 😞

You may create special gameplay, but **expect extra work!**

If you do, we recommend using **tutorials**, **3rd-party assets**, **Copilot**, etc., and we will help you choose the right ones! The **tutors** can help you too!



Milestones During the Semester

Format: Moodle Submissions, Presentations, Builds, etc.

1. Ideation (Creating first ideas)
2. Game Concept
3. Project Plan
4. Work in Progress
5. Playtest
6. Published Game
7. Devlogs & PR Page

Dev Logs

Ongoing development updates,
image or video and text.

At least **1 update from each team member**
during the semester for each project.

Real devlog examples: <https://itch.io/devlogs>

Last year's logs:

<https://hub.hagenberg.games/s/game-production-ss-2025/>

<https://hub.hagenberg.games/s/shadowbound/>

<https://hub.hagenberg.games/s/catalyze-the-catastrophe/>

<https://hub.hagenberg.games/s/dont-get-salty/>

<https://hub.hagenberg.games/s/echoes-of-innsmouth/>

... and even more at <https://hub.hagenberg.games/spaces>



Look! Our character
can jump now!

PR Page / Presskit

Present your game to your audience. Use itch.io as a public platform.

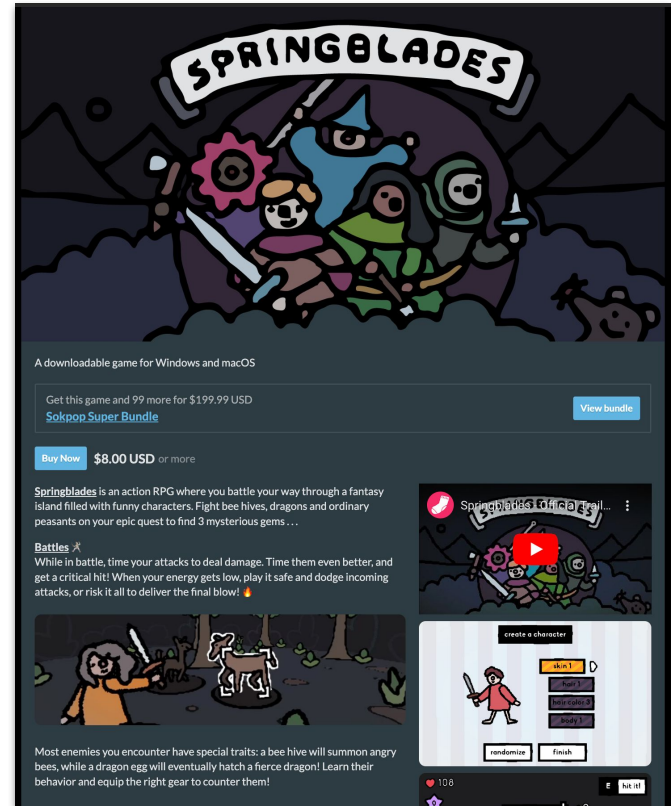
The PR Page should include (for now):

- Header image (flavor)
- Logo
- Short description of your game
- (Optional) info about the developers (you)

Later: screenshots, trailer, build...

[itch.io](https://presskit.itch.io/presskit-template) presskit template (with examples):

<https://presskit.itch.io/presskit-template>





TIME-UP

Let's talk about Time...



WORLD 1 ▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶ P \$26
(M) X 4 0008350 0000



NWR

NintendoWorldReport.com

Recap

4–6 people

2.5 ECTS

1 ECTS = ~25h

How many hours do you have per person & project?

= ~62.5 h / person

= 250–375 h / project

**How much game
can you make in 62.5 hours?**

Research

Global Game Jam (48 hours / 2 days):

<https://globalgamejam.org/games/2026>

Ludum Dare (48 hours / 2 days):

<https://ldjam.com/games>

Epic MegaJam (201 hours / 8+ days):

<https://itch.io/jam/2025-epic-megajam>

Double Fine Amnesia Fortnight (14 days)

<https://www.doublefine.com/games/amnesia-fortnight>

Hagenberg Game Jam (36 hours / 1.5 days):

<https://hagenberg-gamejam.at/>



FOUR SWITCHES AND THREE
BODIES LET A BODY OFF
ONE TO CLOSE GATE &
ROLL OVER IT TO OTHER

JAM DOOR WITH
BODY

WIDE OPEN

BODY STACK GETS CHIPPED
AWAY AS YOU PROGRESS

KICK BODY CHAIN REACTION
TO END ON ALL 3
BUTTONS

PUSH BODY

Game Ideas

ALIVE

DEAD BODIES
FLOAT

CRUMBLE
BLOCKS IN A
WAY THAT
CAUSES
KICKER
BODY
TO DE
STRAI
DOW
UNT
BUTU

HIGH JUMP
TO PUSH DEAD BODY
FARTHER UNDERWATER

USE FANS TO GET BODIES
OUT OF HOLES TO MAKE
MOVING BRIDGE (NOT
ENOUGH PIECES FOR FULL
COVERAGE)

SUSPEND + KICK FOR
MID-AIR TRANSFER

Pitching Ideas: Double Fine Amnesia Fortnight



Make a Game Pitch Video

Create a 30-second game pitch!

- **Exactly** 30 seconds!
- Game title + **Core Idea**
- Smartphone video, images + voiceover (German or English, AI voice possible)
- Record yourself or another person (or nobody!)
- *Can* contain: music, costumes, your or someone else's concept art, reference game footage ...
- Will not be published, but will be viewed by the other students!
- Upload **unlisted** on YouTube, and submit the link in the eLearning platform.
- Add the name of your concept and your name to the description!

Brainstorming

Resources

Miro Boards for Brainstorming

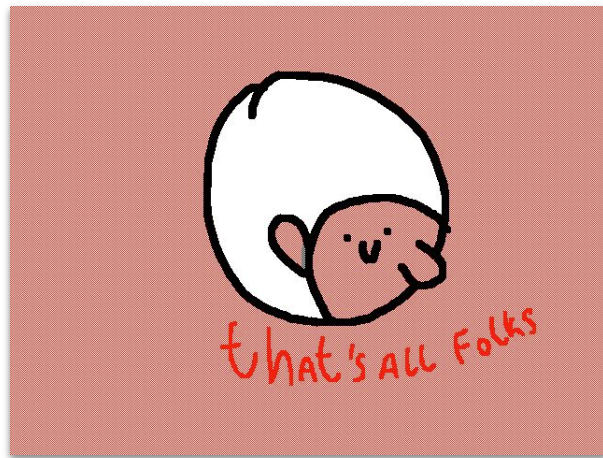
09:40: <https://bit.ly/gap26-da-g1> (DA.ba Gruppe 1)

11:20: <https://bit.ly/gap26-da-g2> (DA.ba Gruppe 2)

13:50: <https://bit.ly/gap26-mtd-g1> (MTD.ba Gruppe 1)

15:30: <https://bit.ly/gap26-mtd-g2> (MTD.ba Gruppe 2)





Thank you!

Next week: pitch videos, group building & concept kick-off!



Title Graphic: Kenney Prototyping Textures

<https://github.com/Calinou/kenney-prototype-textures>